

LOKI'S MISCHIEF

The Elder Futhark Rune Book

24 runes of the oldest runic row — names, sounds,
meanings, and the lore behind each. A plain, sourced guide
for makers and the curious.



What is the Elder Futhark?

The Elder Futhark is the oldest form of the runic alphabets, used by Germanic peoples from roughly the 2nd to 8th century CE. It has 24 runes arranged in three groups of eight called *ættir* (families). Each rune is both a letter (with a phonetic value) and, in later folklore, a symbol. This book gives the reconstructed Proto-Germanic name and sound for each, plus its attested meaning and a short historical note. Divinatory readings are a later layer and are marked as such.



1. Fehu (f) — Cattle, wealth, movable property

Divination (later layer): Abundance, earned reward, momentum — but guard against hoarding.

Ættir: Freyr's Eight (first att)



2. Uruz (u) — Aurochs (wild ox)

Divination (later layer): Raw vitality, primal strength, a force worth taming.

Ættir: Freyr's Eight (first att)



3. Thurisaz (þ (th)) — Thurs (giant), thorn

Divination (later layer): A thorn: danger and catalyst at once. Act with care.

Ættir: Freyr's Eight (first att)



4. Ansuz (a) — God (ansuz), Odinic mouth/word

Divination (later layer): Message, inspiration, the spoken word, Odin's breath.

Ættir: Freyr's Eight (first att)



5. Raidho (r) — Ride, journey, wagon

Divination (later layer): Right movement, rhythm, a journey outward or inward.

Ættir: Freyr's Eight (first att)



6. Kaunan (k) — Torch, ulcer (double sense)

Divination (later layer): Illumination, knowledge that can also burn.

Ættir: Freyr's Eight (first att)



7. Gebo (g) — Gift, exchange

Divination (later layer): Partnership, a gift given and a gift returned. No inverse rune.

Ættir: Freyr's Eight (first att)



8. Wunjo (w) — Joy, bliss, harmony

Divination (later layer): Fulfilment, fellowship, the fruit of the first att.

Ættir: Freyr's Eight (first att)



9. Hagalaz (h) — Hail

Divination (later layer): Disruptive change, a hailstorm that clears the field.

Ættir: Hagal's Eight (second att)



10. Nauthiz (n) — Need, constraint

Divination (later layer): Necessity, friction that forges. Endure to transform.

Ættir: Hagal's Eight (second att)



11. Isa (i) — Ice

Divination (later layer): Stillness, blockage, a clean pause. Wait for the thaw.

Ættir: Hagal's Eight (second att)



12. Jera (j) — Year, harvest, seasonal return

Divination (later layer): Right timing, reward after the cycle completes.

Ættir: Hagal's Eight (second att)



13. Eihwaz (ei) — Yew tree

Divination (later layer): Endurance, the world-axis, life-death-life.

Ættir: Hagal's Eight (second att)



14. Perthro (p) — Lot-box, gaming piece (meaning debated)

Divination (later layer): Mystery, fate's dice-cup, what is hidden.

Ættir: Hagal's Eight (second att)



15. Algiz (z) — Elk, protection

Divination (later layer): A shield-ward, defence, the upward reach.

Ættir: Hagal's Eight (second att)



16. Sowilo (s) — Sun

Divination (later layer): Success, the sun that cannot be lost, clarity.

Ættir: Hagal's Eight (second att)



17. Tiwaz (t) — Tyr (the god), the sky-god

Divination (later layer): Justice, sacrifice, the spear of purpose.

Ættir: Tyr's Eight (third att)



18. Berkana (b) — Birch, Bercht (goddess)

Divination (later layer): Growth, birth, the greening branch.

Ættir: Tyr's Eight (third att)



19. Ehwaz (e) — Horse

Divination (later layer): Movement in partnership, trust, the steed.

Ættir: Tyr's Eight (third att)



20. Mannaz (m) — Man, humanity

Divination (later layer): The self in the collective, the mirror of others.

Ættir: Tyr's Eight (third att)



21. Laguz (l) — Water, lake, flow

Divination (later layer): Intuition, the tide, what moves beneath.

Ættir: Tyr's Eight (third att)



22. Ingwaz (ŋ) — Ing (the god), seed

Divination (later layer): Inner rest, gestation, the seed before sprouting.

Ættir: Tyr's Eight (third att)



23. Dagaz (d) — Day

Divination (later layer): Breakthrough, dawn, the turning point. No inverse rune.

Ættir: Tyr's Eight (third att)



24. Othala (o) — Ancestral property, heritage

Divination (later layer): Roots, inheritance, what was handed down.

Ættir: Tyr's Eight (third att)